The ancient Greeks called the tilt of latitude as '***klima***', literally meaning 'slope' or 'inclination'. Then the earth was divided into seven latitudinal regions, called '***klimata***'. The word came into modern European languages as clime or 'climate', denoting the average weather condition.

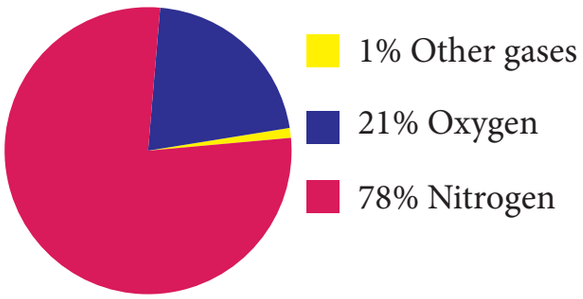


Figure 6.1 Components of Atmosphere

6.2 Composition of the Atmosphere

The atmosphere is essential for the survival of all the organisms on the earth. The atmosphere is a blanket of gases and suspended particles that entirely envelope the earth. It extends outward over thousands of kilometres from the earth's surface. Water vapour, aerosols and tiny solid particles occur in varying quantities as suspended material. These are responsible for weather phenomena as they have ability to absorb and release heat energy.

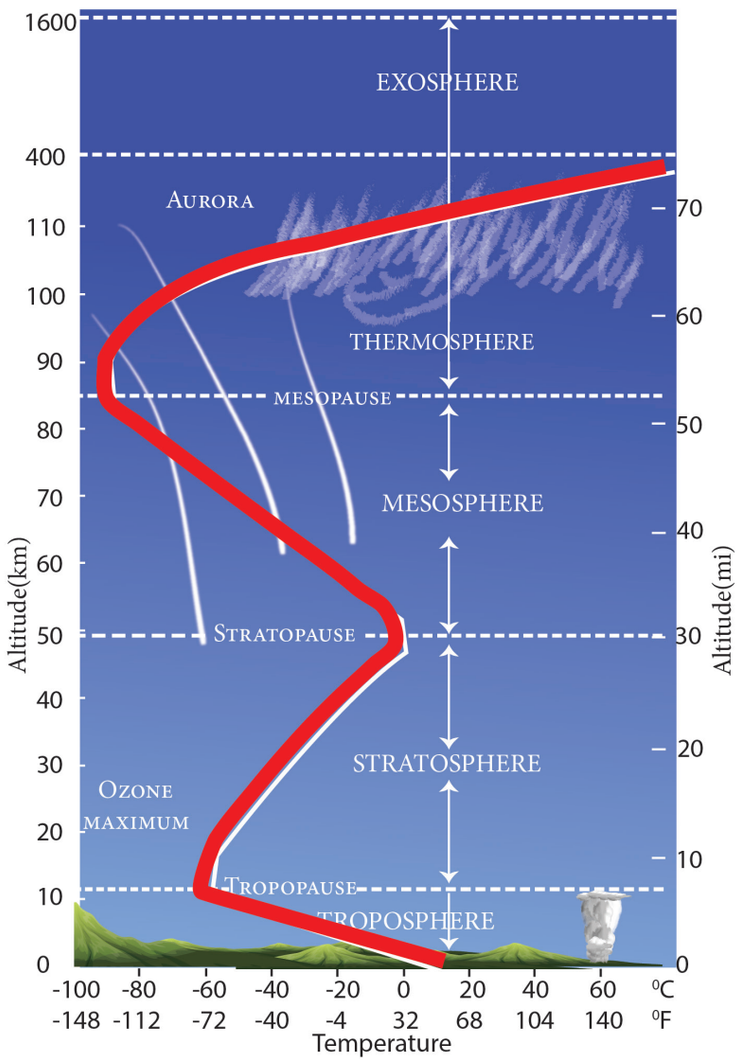


Figure 6.2 Structure of the Atmosphere

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